SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #54 · POLITICS AND GOVERNMENT

“If the right people were in power, I would finally be safe.”

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Where it often comes from

Elections are framed as life-or-death, and each side warns of catastrophe if the other wins. Fear and hope get attached to leaders, and our sense of safety rises and falls with the polls.

What Scripture teaches

“Put not your trust in princes, in mortal man, who cannot save.” “Some trust in chariots and others in horses, but we trust in the name of the LORD our God.” “It is better to take refuge in the LORD than to trust in man.” “The king’s heart is a waterway in the hand of the LORD; He directs it where He pleases.” Paul writes, “there is no authority except that which is from God,” and “do not be afraid, for I am your God.” Leaders matter, and it is good to vote and pray, but safety rests in the Lord, who rules over all rulers.

> *“Put not your trust in princes, in mortal man, who cannot save”* (Psalm 146:3).

Also see

> “Some trust in chariots and others in horses, but we trust in the name of the LORD our God” (Psalm 20:7).

> “It is better to take refuge in the LORD than to trust in man” (Psalm 118:8).

> “The king’s heart is a waterway in the hand of the LORD; He directs it where He pleases” (Proverbs 21:1).

> “He who dwells in the shelter of the Most High will abide in the shadow of the Almighty. I will say to the LORD, ‘You are my refuge and my fortress, my God, in whom I trust.’” (Psalm 91:1–2).

Common self-statements

- If they win, we are doomed.
- Only the right leader can protect me.
- My safety depends on elections.
- I will not be okay until they are in charge.
- The other side will ruin everything.
- I must win.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either safe or in danger depending on who governs.
- Mind reading: Assuming I know what leaders will do.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling afraid and concluding that disaster is coming.
- Fortune telling: Predicting catastrophe.

Challenging questions

- What am I afraid of, specifically?
- Have I felt this fear before in other elections? What happened?
- What does Scripture say about trusting leaders?
- Where does my real security come from?

- What can I control?
- How can I pray and act without putting my trust in leaders?

Truth summary

> My safety and hope are in God, who rules over all rulers. I can vote, pray, and engage thoughtfully without placing the weight of my security on any leader or party.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Fear
- Trust
- Worldly
- Peace
- Anxiety/Worry

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Pride

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "If the right people were in power, I would finally be safe"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If the right people were in power, I would finally be safe." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I fear?
- ☐ What happened before?
- ☐ What does Scripture say?
- ☐ Where is my security?
- ☐ What can I control?
- ☐ How can I pray?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I will not trust in princes.
- ☐ The Lord is my refuge.
- ☐ God directs the hearts of kings.
- ☐ I trust in the name of the Lord.
- ☐ I can vote and pray.
- ☐ My security does not depend on elections.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 146:3
  "Put not your trust in princes, in mortal man, who cannot save."
- ☐ Psalm 20:7
  "Some trust in chariots and others in horses, but we trust in the name of the LORD our God."
- ☐ Psalm 91:1–2
  "He who dwells in the shelter of the Most High will abide in the shadow of the Almighty. I will say to the LORD, 'You are my refuge and my fortress, my God, in whom I trust.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Trust in the Lord: Each week, note one time you moved from fear of leaders to trust in God.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 146:3 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I will not put my trust in princes. The Lord is my refuge.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Trust" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Name the fear. Write what you fear will happen.
- [ ] Look back. Write what happened after past elections.
- [ ] Pray for leaders. Pray for those you support and those you do not.
- [ ] Read Psalm 91. Rest in the shelter of the Most High.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If the right people were in power, I would finally be safe": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Trust in the Lord
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If the right people were in power, I would finally be safe.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have looked to leaders for safety. You are my refuge and fortress. Settle my heart, and help me vote, pray, and live without fear. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.